ORACC SAAo saa02: Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty (SAA 2 6, Q009186) and the Tell Tayinat copy (SAA 2 15, P500551)

- **Texts:**
  - **Q009186 = SAA 2 6**, "Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty" (EST; older name: *Vassal Treaties of Esarhaddon*, VTE). Composite of the Nimrud tablets (ND 4327 ff.; the cdli id P336598 = ND 4336 = BM 132548 is the catalogue's lead tablet), the versions sworn by Median city-rulers (line 1: Ḫumbareš of Naḫšimarti), Nimrud, Nabû temple, 672 BCE (Ayyāru 18, eponymy of Nabû-bēlu-uṣur). **691 composite lines**: seal captions i–iv, lines 1–670, and the "A-lines" 40A–B, 418A–C, 555A–B, 612A–B, 616A, 618A, 633A–C, 636A–C.
  - **P500551 = SAA 2 15**, the **Tell Tayinat copy** (T 1801; Antakya, Archaeological Museum), found 2009 in the temple of Tell Tayinat (ancient Kunalia/Kullania, biblical כַּלְנֵה / כַּלְנוֹ, עמוס ו:ב, ישעיהו י:ט), sworn by the Assyrian governor of Kunalia and his officials; dated Ayyāru 16, 672 BCE. **443 tablet lines** in 8 columns (labels `o <composite line>_T_<column>_<line>`, e.g. `o 1_T_i_1` = composite line 1, Tayinat column i line 1; `o ?_T_...` = not placed in the composite; `o _T_iii_1` = broken, no composite line). Columns ii–iii are badly broken.
- **Editors:**
  - Q009186: S. Parpola and K. Watanabe, *Neo-Assyrian Treaties and Loyalty Oaths* (SAA 2), Helsinki 1988, no. 6. Lemmatised by M. Luukko (2016, LMU Munich, Humboldt Chair of K. Radner).
  - P500551: J. Lauinger, "Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty at Tell Tayinat: Text and Commentary," *JCS* 64 (2012) 87–123. Lemmatised by M. Luukko (2016).
- **URLs:** https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/saao/saa02/Q009186 and .../P500551 (per-text HTML view with translation: append `/html`); data: https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/json/saao-saa02.zip (2.6 MB; JSON export 2024-06-07).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16 (zip) and 2026-10-17 (HTML).
- **Licence:** zip metadata: "CC0"; the per-text credits and the SAAo project pages: "The annotated edition is released under the **Creative Commons Attribution Share-Alike license 3.0**". We treat everything here as **CC BY-SA 3.0**: committed with this attribution. Cite as http://oracc.org/saao/Q009186/ and http://oracc.org/saao/P500551/.

Files

File	What	Committed?
`Q009186--lemmatised.md`	691 lines: transliteration, **`norm:`** (the SAAo normalization, word by word) and `lem:` (citation form[guide word=contextual sense]POS). Converted with `../../../tools/cdl2md.py <zip> saao/saa02/corpusjson/Q009186.json ... --norm`.	yes
`P500551--Tayinat--lemmatised.md`	443 lines, same format.	yes
`Q009186--translation-Parpola-Watanabe.md`	Parpola & Watanabe's English translation (151 units, with the 110 section headings §1–§107, §38A, §54A, §96A), extracted from the HTML view with `../../../tools/oracc_html2tr.py`. **Rank 3: consult only after our own reading.**	yes (CC BY-SA, attributed)
`P500551--Tayinat--translation.md`	Lauinger's English translation of the Tayinat copy (116 units, 92 headings), same tool.	yes (CC BY-SA, attributed)
`Q009186.cdl.json`, `P500551.cdl.json`	raw ORACC CDL JSON (8.7 MB, 4.9 MB), unchanged from the zip.	**no** (> 1 MB; re-extract from the zip)
`Q009186--oracc-view.html`, `P500551--oracc-view.html`	the raw HTML views (1.8 MB, 1.1 MB).	**no** (> 1 MB; re-download with `curl -s --max-time 60 -o ... https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/saao/saa02/<id>/html`)

Line numbering

- **Q009186:** Parpola & Watanabe's composite numbering 1–670 (the standard one in the literature since 1988; Wiseman 1958 numbered by the same lines, so "VTE 1–670" = SAA 2 6 1–670). The section numbers **§1–§107** are Parpola & Watanabe's (they are carried as headings in the translation file, not in the JSON): the literature cites EST both by § and by line. Lines labelled `40A`, `418A` etc. are composite lines inserted after the 1988 numbering was fixed (lines attested in some tablets only). The older literature (Wiseman 1958, Frankena 1965, Weinfeld 1972) cites "VTE" by Wiseman's lines and §§, which P&W kept as far as we can check (Weinfeld's "VTE §§ 39–42", the Sîn → Šamaš → Ninurta → Venus sequence, and "§ 56", the long curse, are P&W §39–42 and §56 = lines 419–430 and 472–493); the A-sections (§38A, §54A, §96A) are P&W's additions. When a citation does not fit, align by content. **Cite by line number.**
- **P500551:** column and line of the Tayinat tablet (i 1 – viii 66 + left edge); each line label also carries the corresponding composite line (`o 418A_T_v_83`), so the two can be aligned by script.

Newer editions and corrections (status 2026-10-17)

- **Lauinger 2012** (JCS 64, University of Chicago Press, DOI 10.5615/jcunestud.64.0087): **not open access** (paywalled at journals.uchicago.edu / JSTOR); not obtained. The ORACC P500551 text and translation are "adapted from" it, so its text is in hand; its commentary is not.
- The **Assur copy** (Frahm 2009, KAL 3 no. 70?, a fragment of an EST tablet from Assur) and later Nimrud joins are **not** in ORACC Q009186 (which is the 1988 composite). Not obtained; record only.
- Lauinger 2015 ("Neo-Assyrian Scribes, 'Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty', and the Dynamics of Textual Mass Production", in Delnero & Lauinger eds., *Texts and Contexts*, de Gruyter) discusses the variants between the copies: not obtained.
- Fales 2012 (*SAAB* 19), Steymans 2013 (*Verbum et Ecclesia* 34, open access) and Levinson & Stackert 2013 (*JAJ* 3) discuss the Tayinat copy and Deuteronomy: see the project's `project.md`.

Usefulness

Rank 1 base text for `חוקים-ובריתות/1-אמנת-הירושה-של-אסרחדון/`. Excellent preservation (about 4% of words in brackets in the composite). The `norm:` line gives the editors' normalization of every word, which the translators parse (stem, tense, subjunctive *-ni*, ventive). Some words (about 130) are unlemmatised (`u`), mostly broken ones. The curse section (§37–§56) is lemmatised partly as Standard Babylonian (it is a literary curse list in SB), the rest as Neo-Assyrian.